

AlpineText-201216kb

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ARROWROOT BARLETY CHERVIL
DUMPLING ENDINE FLAXSEED
GARBANZO HIJIKI ISHTU JICAMA
KALE LYCHEEN MARJORAM
NECTARINE OXTAIL PIZZA
QUINOA ROQUEFORT SQUASH
TOFU UPPUMA VANILLA WHEAT
XERGIS YOGURT ZWEIBACK
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Font Testing Page by Pablo Impallari (impallari.com) and Pablo Cosgaya (omnibus-type.com). Based on Fontdrag (fontdragr.com) and Dave Crossland's FontTest.

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Arrowroot Barlety Chervil Dumpling
Endine Flaxseed Garbanzo Hijiki Ishtu
Jicama Kale Lycheen Marjoram
Nectarine Oxtail Pizza Quinoa
Roquefort Squash Tofu Uppuma
Vanilla Wheat Xergis Yogurt Zweiback
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Doubts over insect-bite treatment

People should consider using a cold, wet cloth to treat insect bites instead of turning to over-the-counter remedies, experts say. Prof Michael Siva-Jothy, from Sheffield University's Department of Animal and Plant Sciences, recruited 29 brave volunteers to test the theory further, watching the bedbugs as they found a place to feed and removing them only as they were about to bite.

An investigation has concluded that there is little evidence that creams, painkillers and anti-inflammatories often used for bites actually work. In any case, said Drug and Therapeutics Bulletin researchers, the reactions got better by themselves in most cases. Midges, mosquitoes, flies, fleas and bedbugs account for most bites. A variety of remedies are sold over the counter in pharmacies to relieve the itching, pain and swelling. Other scientists have suggested that swapping thicker fur for clothes was a way of making insect bites and parasitic infestations less likely. Prof Mark Pagel, an evolutionary biologist at the University of Reading, said that biting parasites remain a major cause of disease and death worldwide, making them a potentially enormous evolutionary pressure on early man.

Cold flannel 'best'

Researchers from the journal reviewed a host of data and evidence published on insect-bite treatments. It concluded in many cases treatments for insect bites had not actually been tested for such purposes. It said medical help should clearly be sought if serious symptoms, such as infections or anaphylactic shock, developed. But it said for simple bites a flannel or cloth soaked in cold water often worked best - despite advice from official bodies, such as NHS Choices, suggesting treatments should be used. David Phizackerley, the deputy editor of the journal, said: "People are using these treatments so they should know there is no evidence they work. [Most] bites will get better on their own." Hungry bugs placed on shaved arms were more likely to try to feed compared with those on unshaved arms, the journal Biology Letters reported. Researchers say the hair slows down the bedbugs and warns the victim. Pest controllers say the UK is currently experiencing a steep rise in the number of bed bug infestations. Prof Michael Siva-Jothy, from Sheffield University's Department of Animal and Plant Sciences, recruited 29 brave volunteers to test the theory further, watching the bedbugs as they found a place to feed and removing them only as they were about to bite. This tallies with other studies which look at how humans came to be relatively less hairy than apes.

1. Preface
2. Pre-Hot 100 era
3. Hot 100 era
4. Sources
5. See also

He found that more layers of both longer visible hairs and finer, "vellus" hairs near the surface appeared to work as a deterrent to the insects, with the finer hairs also acting as an early warning system. Continue reading the main story "Start Quote If you have a heavy coat of long thick hairs it is easier for parasites to hide" Professor Siva-Jothy Sheffield University Prof Siva-Jothy said: "Our findings show that more body hairs mean better detection of parasites - the hairs have nerves attached to them and provide us with the ability to detect displacement." He said they also slowed down the insect as it searched for a tasty spot to bite. "The results have implications for understanding why we look the way we do, what selective forces might have driven us to look the way we do, and may even provide insight for better understanding of how to reduce biting insects' impact on humans." However, even though men are naturally hairier than women, they do not appear to be bitten less often. Professor Siva-Jothy suggested this pointed to an evolutionary battle between bed bugs and their prey, with the insects adapting to automatically head for relatively hairless bits of the body, such as wrists and ankles. He added that extreme hairiness might also be more of a disadvantage than an advantage. If you have a heavy coat of long thick hairs it is easier for parasites to hide, even if you can detect them. "Our proposal is that we retain the fine covering because it aids detection and if we lost all hair, even the relatively invisible fine hair, our detection ability goes right down."

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Grumpy wizards make toxic brew for the evil Queen and Jack. One morning, when Gregor Samsa woke from troubled dreams, he found himself transformed in his bed into a horrible vermin. He lay on his armour-like back, and if he lifted his head a little he could see his brown belly, slightly domed and divided by arches into stiff sections. The bedding was hardly able to cover it and seemed ready to slide off any moment. His many legs, pitifully thin compared with the size of the rest of him, waved about helplessly as he looked. 01234567890

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